

0.0.1 The Triple Knowledge (excerpt)

tevijjasuttaṃ (excerpt)

1. Thus was heard by me: At one time the Auspicious One was wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, when they arrived at a brahmin village of the Kosalans named Manasakata. There the Auspicious One dwelled at a mango grove north of Manasakata on the bank of the Aciravati river.

evammesutaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā kosalesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi yena manasākaṭaṃ nāma kosalānaṃ brāhmaṇagāmo tadavasari. tatra sudaṃ bhagavā manasākaṭe viharati uttarena manasākaṭassa aciravatiyā nadiyā tīre ambavane.

2. At that time many well-known wealthy brahmins were dwelling at Manasakata, such as: the brahmin Canki, the brahmin Tarukkha, the brahmin Pokkharasati, the brahmin Janussoṇi, the brahmin Todeyya, and many other well-known and wealthy brahmins.

tena kho pana samayena sambahulā abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā manasākaṭe paṭivasanti, seyyathidaṃ: caṅkī brāhmaṇo, tārukko brāhmaṇo, pokkharasātī brāhmaṇo, jāṇussoṇī brāh-

maṇo, todeyyo brāhmaṇo, aññe ca abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā.

3. Now for Vasettha and Bharadvaja, while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this topic of conversation about path and non-path arose. Then the brahmin youth Vasettha said thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Pokkharasati.”

atha kho vāseṭṭha-bhāradvājānaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamantānaṃ anuvicarantānaṃ maggāmagge kathā udapādi. atha kho vāseṭṭho māṇavo evamāha: ‘ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāniko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena pokkharasātina’ti.

4. The brahmin youth Bharadvaja said thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Tarukkha.” Neither was the brahmin youth Vasettha able to convince the brahmin youth Bharadvaja, nor was the brahmin youth Bharadvaja able to convince the brahmin youth Vasettha.

bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: ayameva ujumaggo

ayamaññasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena tā-rukkhenā'ti. neva khvāsakkhi1 vāsetṭho māṇavo bhāradvājaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ. na panāsakkhi bhāradvājo māṇavo vāsetṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ.

5. So then, the brahmin youth Vasettha address the brahmin youth, Bharadvaja. Master Bharadvaja, there is this samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans who has gone forth from the Sakyan clan, dwelling at a mango grove north of Manasakata on the bank of the Aciravati river. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: "Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious." We must visit with the samana Gotama, O Master Bharadvaja. Upon arrival, we must ask the samana Gotama about this matter. In which ever way the samana Gotama will answer, in just that way we must bear it in mind." "Yes sir." The brahmin youth Bharadvaja replied to the brahmin youth Vasettha.

atha kho vāsetṭho māṇavo bhāradvājaṃ māṇavaṃ āmantesi: ayaṃ kho bhāradvāja, samaṇo gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito manasākaṭe viharati uttarena manasākaṭassa aciravatiyā nadiyā tīre ambavane. taṃ kho pana bhavantam gota-

maṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: itipi so bhagavā arahaṃ sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadammasārathi satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavā'ti. āyāma bho bhāradvāja, yena samaṇo gotamo tenupasaṅkamissāma. upasaṅkamitvā etaṃ matthaṃ samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ pucchissāma. ya-thā no samaṇo gotamo byākarissati, tathā naṃ dhāressāmāti. 'evambho'ti kho bhāradvājo māṇavo vāseṭṭhassa māṇavassa paccassosi.

6. So then, the brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvaja visited with the Auspicious One. Having approached, they exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin youth Vasettha said this to the Auspicious One: "Here Master Gotama, for us while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this topic of conversation about path and non-path arose. I said thus: "This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Pokkharasati." The brahmin youth Bharadvaja said thus: "This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Tarukkha." Here Master Gotama, there is really a dispute, there is a contention, there is a

difference of views.”

atha kho vāsetṭhabhāradvājā māṇavā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamimṣu. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodimṣu. sammodanīyaṃ kaṭṭhaṃ sārāṇiyaṃ vītisāretvā ekamantaṃ nisīdimṣu. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho vāsetṭho māṇavo bhagavantaṃ etadavoca: “idha bho gotama amhākaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamantānaṃ anuvicāraṇānaṃ maggāmagge kathā udapādi. ahaṃ evaṃ vadāmi: ‘ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena pokkharasātina’ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: ‘ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena tārukkenā’ti. ettha bho gotama, attheva viggaho atthi vivādo, atthi nānāvādo”ti.

7. Thus apparently, O Vasettha, you say thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Pokkharasati.” The brahmin youth Bharadvaja say thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Tarukkha.” But what, O Vasettha, is your dispute, what is the contention, what is the difference of

views?”

“iti kira vāseṭṭha, tvaṃ evaṃ vadesi: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena pokkharasātinā’ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena tārukkenāti. atha kismiṃ pana vo vāseṭṭhā viggaho? kismiṃ vivādo? kismiṃ nānāvādo?”ti.

8. “About path and non-path, O Master Gotama. Even though, O Master Gotama, the brahmins declare various paths: that of the Addhariya brahmins, the Tittiriya brahmins, the Chandoka brahmins, the Bavhira brahmins, they all lead to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma. Just as, O Master Gotama, not too far from a village or market town, even if there are various paths, all converge on the village. So too, O Master Gotama, even though the brahmins declare various paths: that of the Addhariya brahmins, the Tittiriya brahmins, the Chandoka brahmins, the Bavhira brahmins, they all lead to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma.”

“maggāmagge bho gotama. kiñcāpi bho gotama brāhmaṇā nānāmagge paññāpenti addhariyā brāhmaṇā, tittiriya brāhmaṇā. chandokā brāhmaṇā,

bavhīricā¹ brāhmaṇā, atha kho sabbāni tāni niyyāṇikāni niyyanti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya. seyyathāpi bho gotama gāmassa vā nigamassa vā avidūre bahūni cepi nānāmaggaṇi bhavanti, atha kho sabbāni tāni gāmasamosaraṇāni bhavanti. evameva kho bho gotama kiñcāpi brāhmaṇā nānāmagge paññāpenti addhāriyā brāhmaṇā, tittiriya brāhmaṇā, chandokā brāhmaṇā, bavhīricā brāhmaṇā, atha kho sabbāni tāni niyyāṇikāni niyyanti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya”ti.

9. Do you say, “delivering,” O Vasettha?

“niyyantīti vāseṭṭha vadesi?”

10. I say, “delivering,” O Master Gotama.

“niyyantīti bho gotama vadāmi”.

11. Do you say, “delivering,” O Vasettha?

“niyyantīti vāseṭṭha vadesi?”

12. I say, “delivering,” O Master Gotama.

“niyyantīti bho gotama vadāmi”.

13. Do you say, “delivering,” O Vasettha?

“niyyantīti vāseṭṭha vadesi?”

14. I say, “delivering,” O Master Gotama.

“niyyantīti bho gotama vadāmi”.

15. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one brahmin who is able to see Brahma?”

“kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekabrāhmaṇo’pi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho?”ti.

16. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

“no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

17. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one teacher who is able to see Brahma?”

“kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyo’pi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho?”ti.

18. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

“no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

19. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one teacher of teachers who is able to see Brahma?”

“kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyapācariyo’pi yena brahmā sak-khidiṭṭho?”ti.

20. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

“no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

21. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one in the seven generations of teachers who is able to see Brahma?”).

“kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ yāva sattamā ācariyamahayugā yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho?”ti.

22. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

“no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

23. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Even the ancient triple-knowledge brahmin seers, composers of the

mantras, proclaimers of the mantras, this ancient mantra verses proclaimed and composed [by them], of which at present, the triple-knowledge brahmins chant, recite, rehearse, continuously repeating what was said, causing to pass down what has been recited, that is to say: Attaka, Vamaka, Vamadeva, Vessamitta, Yamataggi, Angirasa, Bharadvaja, Vasettha, Kassapa, Bhagu, do they even speak thus: “We know thus, we see thus, how Brahma or when Brahma or where Brahma [appears].”

“kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, ye’pi tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ pubbakā isayo mantānaṃ kattāro mantānaṃ pavattāro yesamidam etarahi tevijjā brāhmaṇā porāṇaṃ mantapadaṃ gītaṃ pavuttaṃ samūhitaṃ tadanugāyanti tadanubhāsanti bhāsitamanubhāsanti vācītanamanuvācenti, seyyathidaṃ: aṭṭako vāmakō vāmadevo vessāmitto yamataggi āṅgīraso bhāradvājo vāseṭṭho kassapo bhagu, te’pi evamāhaṃsu: mayametaṃ jānāma mayametaṃ passāma yattha vā brahmā yena vā brahmā yaḥiṃ vā brahmā’ti?”.

24. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

“no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

25. Thus apparently, O Vasettha, among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one brahmin who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher who is

able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher of teachers who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one in the seven generations of teachers who is able to see Brahma.

iti kira vāsetṭha natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekabrāhmaṇopi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyopi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyapācariyopi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ yāva sattamā ācariyamahayugā yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho -

26. Apparently, even the ancient triple-knowledge brahmin seers, composers of the mantras, proclaimers of the mantras, this ancient mantra verses proclaimed and composed [by them], of which at present, the triple-knowledge brahmins chant, recite, rehearse, continuously repeating what was said, causing to pass down what has been recited, that is to say: Attaka, Vamaka, Vamadeva, Vessamitta, Yamataggi, Angirasa, Bharadvaja, Vasettha, Kassapa, Bhagu, even they do not speak thus: “We know thus, we see thus, how Brahma or when Brahma or where Brahma [appears].” Surely those triple-knowledge brahmins who speak thus: “We teach the path to union with that which we do not know, to that which we do not see, this is the only straight path, this is

the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma.”

yepi kira tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ pubbakā isayo mantānaṃ kattāro mantānaṃ pavattāro, yesami-daṃ etarahi tevijjā brāhmaṇā porāṇaṃ mantapa-daṃ gītaṃ pavuttaṃ samūhitaṃ tadanugāyanti tadanubhāsanti bhāsitamanubhāsanti vācitam-anuvācenti, seyyathīdaṃ: atṭako vāmako vāmadevo vessāmitto yamataggi aṅgirasso bhāradvājo vāseṭṭho kassapo bhagu, tepi na evamāhaṃsu: maya-metaṃ jānāma mayametaṃ passāma yattha vā brahmā yena vā brahmā yaḥim vā brahmāti. te vata tevijjā brāhmaṇā evamāhaṃsu: yaṃ mayaṃ na jānāma yaṃ na passāma, tassa saḥavyatāya maggaṃ desema: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañja-sāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasaḥavyatāyāti.

27. “So what do you think, O Vasettha, that being so, doesn’t the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar?”

taṃ kimmaññasi vāseṭṭha, tanu evaṃ sante tevij-jānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihīrakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati?ti.

28. “Certainly, O Master Gotama, that being so, the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out

to be less than stellar.”

addhā kho bho gotama, evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ
brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihīrakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampaj-
jatīti.

29. Good Vasettha. Indeed O Vasettha, that those triple-knowledge brahmins [could] teach a path to union with that which they do not know, that which they do not see, [claiming]: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma,” this possibility is not to be found. Just as, O Vasettha, a line of blind men go on in succession holding on to each other, the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. So too, O Vasettha, the statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins seem to me like a line of blind men; the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. These statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be mere speech, turn out to be mere words, turn out to be simply empty, turn out to be simply hollow.

sādhū vāseṭṭha. te vata vāseṭṭha tevijjā brāhmaṇā
yaṃ na jānanti yaṃ na passanti tassa saḥavya-
tāya maggaṃ desessanti: ayameva ujumaggo aya-
mañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāni takkarassa brah-
masahavyatāyāti netam ṭhānaṃ vijjati. seyyathāpi
vāseṭṭha andhaveniparamparaṃ saṃsattā purimopi

na passati majjhimopi na passati pacchimopi na passati, evameva kho vāsetṭha andhavenūpamaṃ maññe tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ bhāsitaṃ. purimopi na passati. majjhimopi na passati. pacchimopi na passati. tesamidaṃ tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ bhāsitaṃ bhassakaññeva sampajjati, nāmakaññeva sampajjati. rittakaññeva sampajjati, tucchakaññeva sampajjati.

